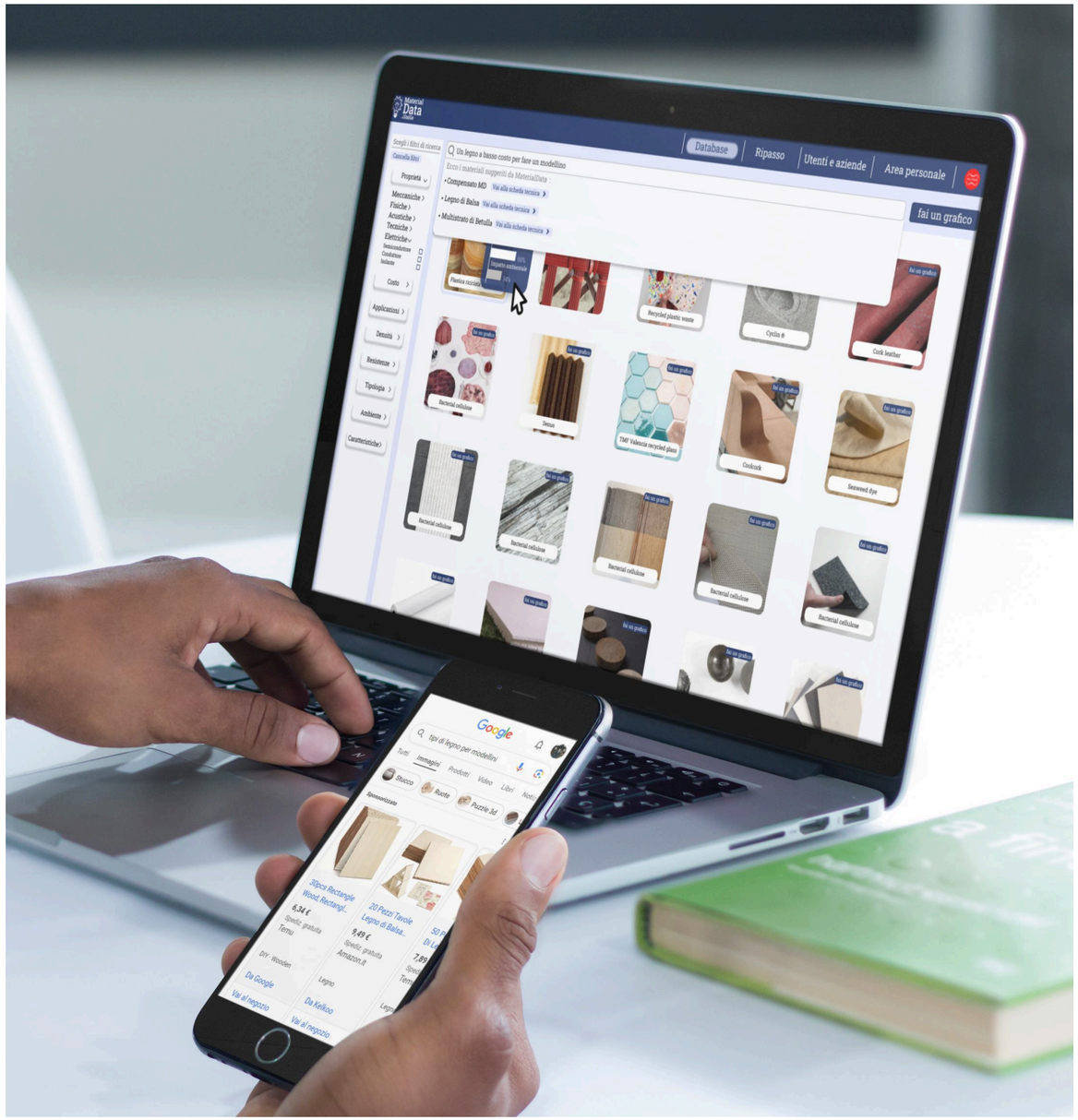
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2024

MaterialData

A digital material library and learning tool for university students and teachers



Methods & tools: *desk research · benchmark analysis · semi-structured interviews · user flow · wireframes · visual identity · Figma · Sketching*

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WHY A MATERIAL LIBRARY?

The early stages



WHAT IS A MATERIAL LIBRARY

A material library is a collection or archive of materials. They are technological archives that serve as tools for **knowledge dissemination and technical information**. They can also have educational purposes, aiming to enhance the training of university students and deepen their understanding in the **fields of construction, architecture, and design.**



THE IDEA

This project started from a clear concept: **universities must provide the right tools to create an environment that fosters study, concentration, and creativity for all students.**
This led to a fundamental question:
Does the University of Genoa provide students with everything they need to make their education as complete as possible?
A material library could serve as a r**eference tool for designers, helping them choose the most suitable materials for their projects.**

Material Data .UniGe

THE OUTCOME

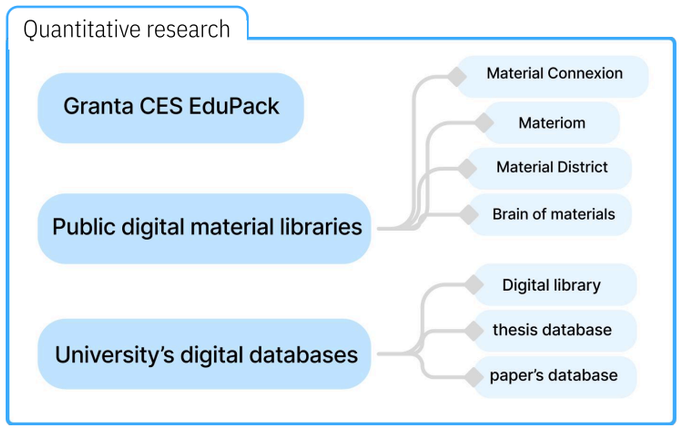
Given the wide range of materials currently in production, and those in development, such as plant-based materials, bioplastics, and others, it is also **necessary for this archive to feature an interface that allows easy navigation of a digital database.**
For this reason, the idea was born to create a digital (and potentially physical) material library specifically for the Department of Architecture and Design.

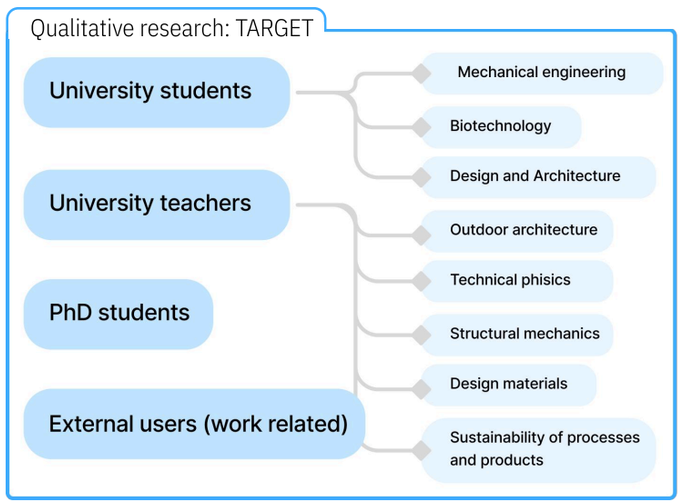
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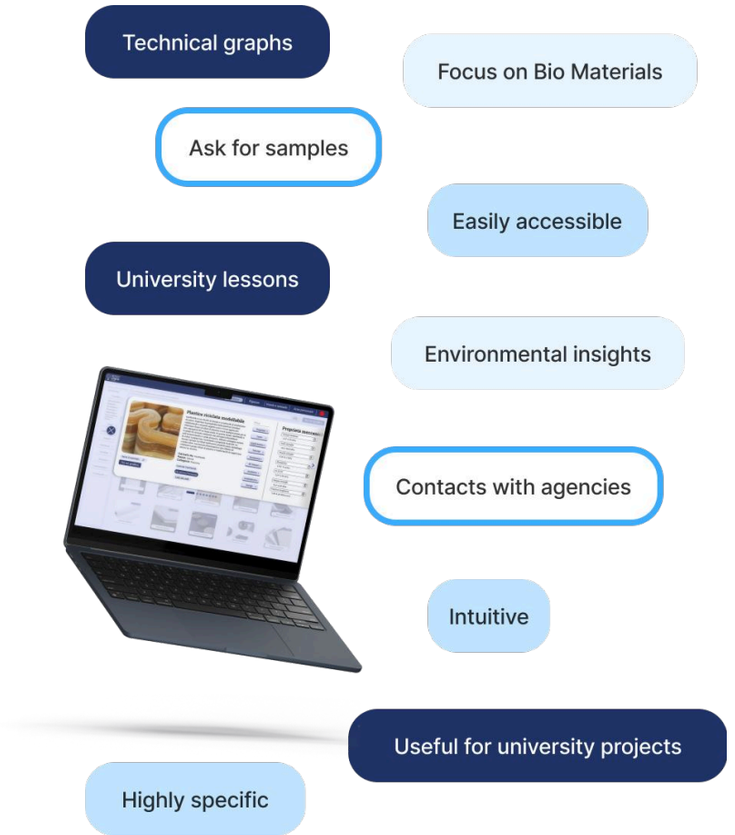
BUILDING THE PLATFORM

The research and the main features

To develop the platform as efficiently as possible, multiple research techniques were employed. The process began with a study and **analysis of existing online material libraries**, followed by an e**valuation of the online services offered by the university**. **Targeted interviews** were then conducted to understand the opinions and needs of potential users.

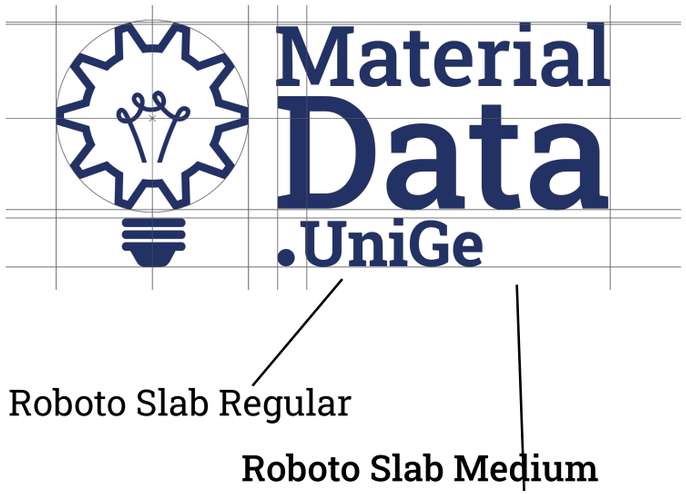






THE OUTCOME OF THE RESEARCH

The research results were essential in designing both the interface and functionality of the platform. A common requirement was the need for a **student-friendly, accessible, and easy-to-navigate tool**. It is important to note that the platform is first introduced to students through a **specific course**, where its features and capabilities are explained in a guided manner to ensure maximum clarity.



RGB 248 249 253
CMYK 3 2 0 0
f8f9fd

RGB 224 230 255
CMYK 14 9 0 0
e0e6ff

RGB 0 38 119
CMYK 99 86 0 7
002677

RGB 255 255 255
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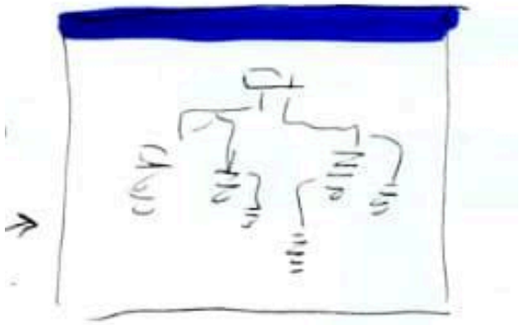
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VISUAL IDENTITY

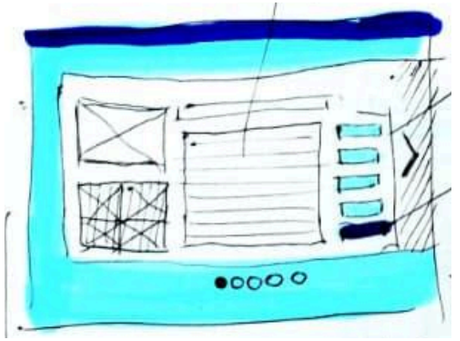
For the graphic design, inspiration was drawn from the **primary color used in the visual identity of the Department** of Architecture and Design at the University of Genoa: **blue #002677**. The font used is also the one adopted for the university's visual communication.
The logo features a lightbulb-gear monogram, symbolizing the **union of work and ideas**. This represents the material library as a crucial tool for developing ideas and creating projects in the most effective way.

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THE USER FLOW - A STUDY



Main page

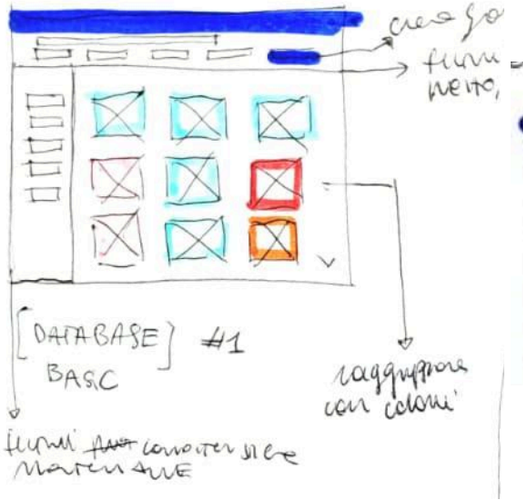


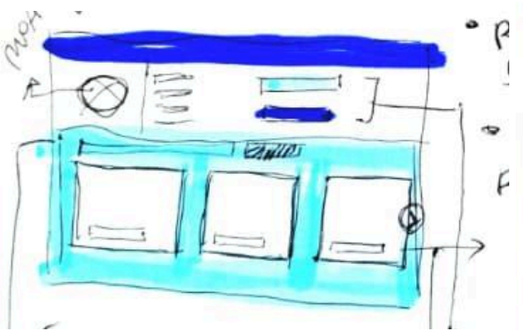
Material sheet

SKETCHING WIREFRAMES

A thorough study was made to accomplish the most easy userflow for the platform : starting from the opening screen to the various functionalities. In this page a few of these studies are represented to achieve a smooth walkthrough of the thinking behind it.

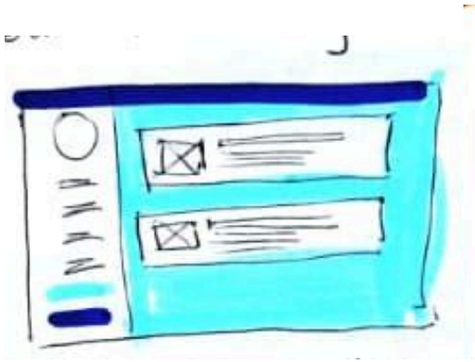
Material selection

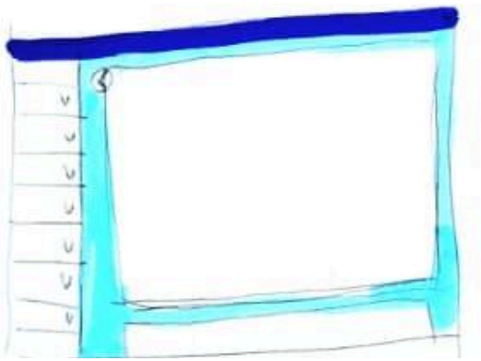




Study on material selection

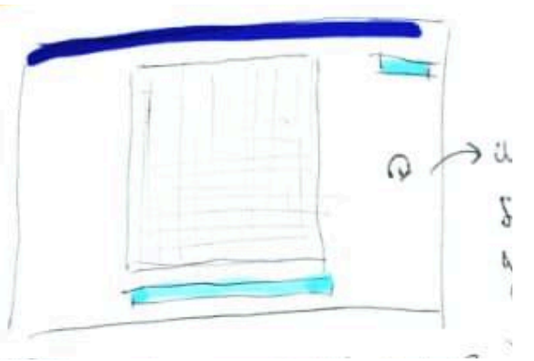
Personal page

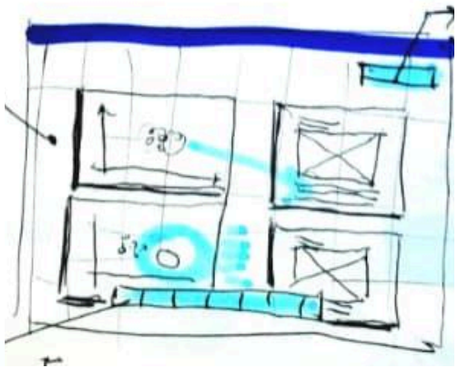




Study section

Adding a project



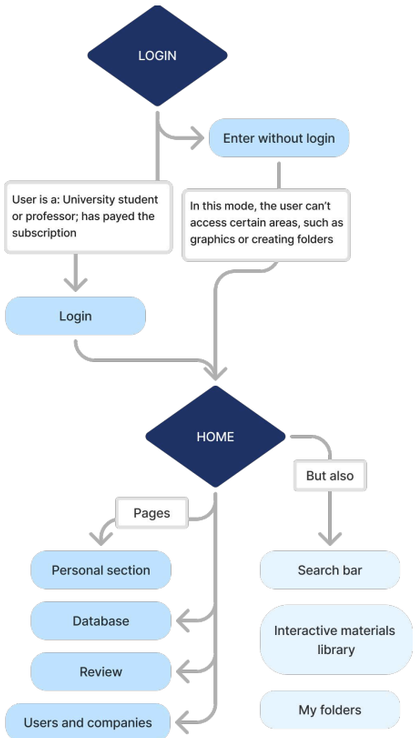


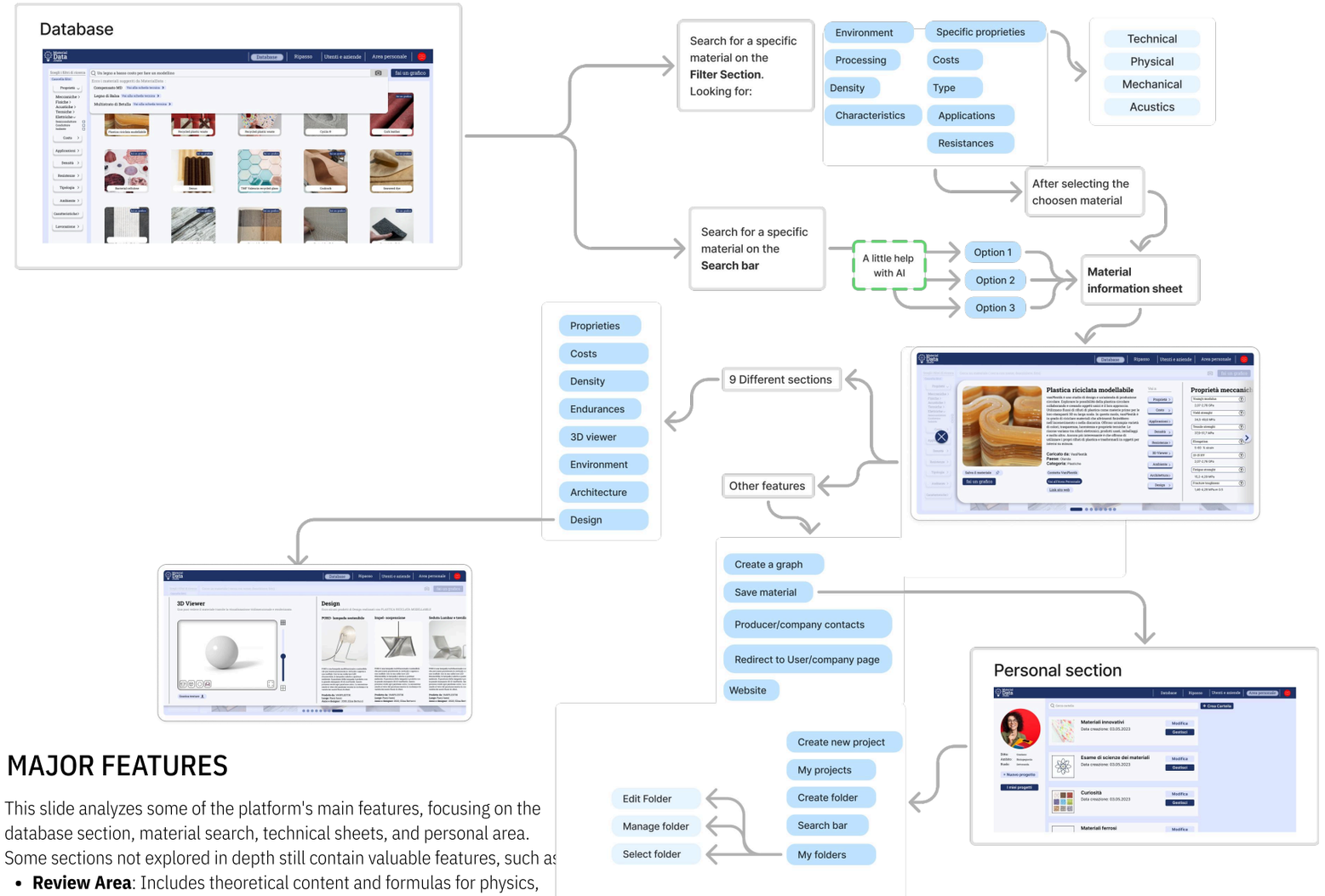
Working space

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THE USER FLOW

The main sections of the platform





PLATFORM ACCESS

For this project, the decision was made to create a **platform available for free to all students, faculty, and researchers** at the University of Genoa (with the service funded through tuition fees). However, access is also available to external users for a fee.
The reason behind this choice is to expand access to a resource that is already partially available to students in the Product and Communication Design course through Granta EduPack, making it accessible to the entire University of Genoa.

MAJOR FEATURES

This slide analyzes some of the platform's main features, focusing on the database section, material search, technical sheets, and personal area. Some sections not explored in depth still contain valuable features, such as:

- **Review Area**: Includes theoretical content and formulas for physics, mathematics, and analysis
- **Users & Companies**: Listed alphabetically, allowing users to view uploaded projects and materials when selected

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Elisa Maria Bertucci - Portfolio 2026

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